



Zooming Ahead

A total of 8,557 MoUs were signed at the summit

USEL GROUP, Singapore

Rs 87,000 cr to be invested in 10 years in a 10,000-MW power project and ports and other infrastructure.

HINDUSTAN CONSTRUCTION

Rs 40,000 cr which will be used for setting up a waterfront city near Dholera.

STATE BANK OF INDIA

Rs 30,000 cr to be spent on opening 45 new branches and funding SMEs.

SABEER BHATIA

Rs 30,000 cr will be spent on a sustainable, hi-tech Nano city.

ADANI GROUP

Rs 27,000 cr on infrastructure projects.

MODI TAKES A TEST DRIVE OF THE NANO IN AHMEDABAD

evolved by the state's industries department is unique and is based on a special software developed by the Government's Bhaskaracharya Institute. It has a database of infrastructural facilities available for various industries right till the village level. It covers details of power, water, industrial gas availability and connectivity via roads, ports and railways. This supplements the macro picture of sector-wise industrial regions and related infrastructure. The software helps investors select the right site in the shortest possible time. The Government also has a very strong monitoring system backed by a special software. The progress of each project is mapped by the district collector and the chief secretary at the state level once a month and a progress report given to the chief minister. Says Modi: "Thanks to our integrated approach to governance, Vibrant Gujarat is on auto pilot now. Now we plan to turn the next summit in 2011 into another Davos."

The success of the summit goes as much to Modi's vision as to his committed team of officials, the "Super Eight"—Chief Secretary D. Rajagopalan, Principal Secretary to Chief Minister K. Kailashnathan, Secretary A.K. Sharma, Gujarat

six months but what we experienced in Gujarat was simply unimaginable. Gujarat is head and shoulders above many other states as an investment destination." Birla was no less lavish: "We need many more Narendra Modis to make India a superpower." The small print was more radical: most Indian corporate honchos who spoke on the occasion wanted Modi to be India's prime minister.

A close look at how Modi and his team of committed officials have worked to make Gujarat an ideal destination for investment is an interesting study. He has led purposeful policy changes in step with the changing times to create the right atmosphere. For example he was able to hand over the possession of land for the Nano project in record time because



“If one Dhirubhai could do so much just imagine what 10 Dhirubhais could have done. For Modi too, one can say the same thing. He is the next leader of India.”

ANIL AMBANI, chairman, ADAG Group

the Modi Government had carried out crucial land reforms last year to facilitate easy transfer of agriculture and other land for the industrial sector. Gujarat's sez laws makes the task of setting them up much easier compared to other states.

For attracting investors, the Modi Government has set up smooth facilitating mechanisms. For example, the investor support system

Industrial Development Corporation MD M. Sahu, Industry Secretary Gauri Kumar, Industries Commissioner S. Gulati and IAS officials in the industries department Rajiv Topno and Mamta Verma. These people worked meticulously to make the event a success. Clearly, in times of economic and investment meltdown, Gujarat is proving that it need not be all doom and gloom. ■